bisected Pangong Lake, and further south it was set at the Demchok River. This is the customary boundary between India and China in eastern Ladakh, but its alignment is contested at various points. Tibet conceded to Ladakh an enclave at Kailash–Mansarovar, known as Minsar. Enclaves were also conceded to Bhutan in western Tibet, including several along Mansarovar lake. These survived up until the establishment of the PRC in 1949.

A Sikh invasion of western Tibet under Maharaja Ranjit Singh's general Zorawar Singh failed, and as a result the two sides concluded a treaty in 1842, which reaffirmed the provisions of the Tingmosgang treaty of 1684, including the alignment of the boundary. However, no map was prepared to show this alignment. Ladakh was incorporated in Maharaja Ranjit Singh's Sikh kingdom in 1843 and was eventually attached to the princely state of Jammu and Kashmir in 1846.

The recent clashes between India and China in eastern Ladakh have arisen due to China interpreting the alignment of the so-called 'customary boundary' included in the treaty to its advantage. There being no map attached to the treaty and the terrain being vast and devoid of prominent terrain features, the alignment is ambiguous, and this has been exploited by the Chinese to advance claims in several sections, such as the Depsang plains and the Chip-Chap River valley.

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To return to central Tibet: from the tenth to the thirteenth centuries, the country was broken up into competing principalities ruled by warlords and feudal families. However, the various Buddhist monasteries continued to flourish, and these were headed by eminent monks and clerics. The Sakya monastery located not far from the city of Shigazi, where Tibet's second most important monastery, the Tashilumpo, is located, [2] was a pre-eminent monastic centre, which had been established in 1073 CE by Khon Konchok Gyalpo. Its abbots were well respected and influential.

The prolonged period of political fragmentation of Tibet came to an end when it fell under Mongol rule in the thirteenth century. During this time, it was the presiding abbot of the Sakya monastery, Kunga Gyaltsen, who